NexAI Hack 2026 — Participant Instructions

1. Schedule and Problem Selection

- **Start:** Begin development after the inaugural orientation at **6:00 PM on 21 October 2026**.
- **Deadline:** Final submission at around **3:30 PM onwards on 22 October 2026**.
- **Progress reviews:** Teams may be asked to demonstrate their progress during the event.
- **Problem selection:** Choose one of the 12 shared problem statements. Multiple teams may select the same problem.
- **Core requirements:** Complete the three mandatory requirements in your selected problem statement before attempting stretch goals.

2. Preparation Before the Event

You may review datasets, explore the technology stack, develop ideas, and plan your solution beforehand. Solution development must begin after kickoff.

- Shortlist one or two problems and review their **Data & Resources** sections.
- Create a GitHub account, a deployment account, and an API key if required.
- Install your preferred development tools and test the required libraries.
- Download only the specified dataset or subset to minimise campus bandwidth usage.

3. Development and Code Requirements

- Maintain a **public GitHub repository from kickoff** and commit progress at least hourly.
- Commit history will be reviewed. A single bulk submission or evidence of solution development before kickoff may trigger a disqualification review.
- Framework starters, open-source libraries, and AI coding tools are permitted. Declare the tools and dependencies in the README.
- Store credentials in environment variables and provide a .env.example file. Rotate any exposed key immediately.
- Every team member must be able to explain the submitted solution, including AI-generated code.
- A **DEV_LOG.md** is encouraged to record key decisions, AI assistance, experiments, and rejected approaches.

4. Deployment

- Provide a publicly accessible application URL by the submission deadline.
- Free hosting platforms such as Vercel, Render, Netlify, Cloudflare, or Hugging Face Spaces are acceptable.
- If model size prevents deployment on a free tier, demonstrate the application locally to the judges and provide a YouTube demo linked in the README.

5. Data and Responsible AI

- Use the recommended datasets, suitably licensed public datasets, or clearly identified synthetic data.
- Do not use scraped personal data or private company data.
- Evaluate models on a held-out split, report metrics honestly, and state limitations.
- **Fabricated results will result in disqualification.**

6. README Requirements

Include:

- Problem statement and solution overview
- Architecture diagram and technology stack
- Setup and execution instructions ;
- Deployment URL or approved local-demo details
- Dataset attribution and licence
- Team member details
- Link to DEV_LOG.md, if maintained

7. Public Posts

Before submission, publish posts on **LinkedIn and X** describing the problem and your solution. Include a screenshot or short clip, repository URL, and deployment URL where available.

Use **#NEXAI2026**, tag your teammates, and include the official conclave handles once announced.

8. Final Submission

Submit the following by **3:00 PM onwards on 22 October 2026**:

1. Public GitHub repository URL
2. Live deployment URL, or local-demo details where the deployment exception applies
3. Demo recording of up to **5 minutes &** Pitch deck in PowerPoint format
4. LinkedIn and X post URLs

Bonus: A public or unlisted YouTube overview of up to **3 minutes**, linked in the README and public posts, and completion of problem-specific stretch goals.

9. Demonstration and Evaluation

Final demonstrations will follow code freeze; the detailed schedule will be announced. Each team will receive **5 minutes for the demonstration and 3 minutes for Q&A**.

Demonstrate the deployed application wherever possible. Recorded demonstrations serve as a fallback, subject to the deployment exception above.